Tools & External Resources

Updated: 2026-10-26.

Your Weekly Tool

Student_Toolkit.xlsx — in this folder. Contains your Interview Log, Experiment Tracker, and KPI Dashboard. This is the ONE file you use every week.

Legal & Fundraising

YC SAFE Agreement (Simple Agreement for Future Equity)

https://www.ycombinator.com/documents The standard early-stage investment document. Used by thousands of startups. Free, open-source. Don't let a lawyer charge you €5,000 to draft something worse.

Sequoia Capital — Writing a Business Plan

https://www.sequoiacap.com/article/writing-a-business-plan/ The industry-standard pitch deck structure. Problem, Solution, Why Now, Market, Competition, Product, Business Model, Team, Financials, Ask.

Building & Prototyping

The concepts matter more than the tool (Module 06). Pick the one your team already knows.

AI app builders and coding agents

Examples, not endorsements: Lovable, Replit, Claude Code, Cursor. Brief it in writing, one small step at a time, and save every version.

Google Sheets

https://sheets.google.com Your first database. Many prototypes need nothing more.

Microsoft Clarity

https://clarity.microsoft.com Session recordings and heatmaps of your live page or MVP. EU visitors must consent first, see Legal Basics.

Claude / ChatGPT

For everything else — writing copy, analyzing interviews, generating code, brainstorming solutions. Use AI as your first employee.

What AI Can Do, and the Rules

An Opinionated Guide to Which AI to Use (Ethan Mollick, July 2026)

https://www.oneusefulthing.org/p/an-opinionated-guide-to-which-ai-b22 Which tool for which job, and why you should give an agent a real task from your own work. About ten minutes.

Navigating the Jagged Technological Frontier (Organization Science, 2026)

https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.21838 758 BCG consultants worked with and without GPT-4. On tasks inside the frontier they were faster and better. On one task just outside it, 84.5% got it right without AI and only 60% to 70.6% with it. So test AI on tasks whose answer you know before you trust it with your research. Open access.

METR: Measuring AI Ability to Complete Long Tasks

https://metr.org/blog/2025-03-19-measuring-ai-ability-to-complete-long-tasks/ How long a task an AI agent finishes on its own, and how fast that grows. The length has doubled about every seven months since 2019. Read it before you promise what your AI feature will do alone.

AI Literacy, Questions and Answers (European Commission)

https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/faqs/ai-literacy-questions-answers What Article 4 of the EU AI Act asks of every company that uses AI, as amended in July 2026. No certificate is required. Read it before your team or your customers rely on your AI.

Validation & PMF Measurement

Sean Ellis PMF Survey (Free Tool)

https://pmfsurvey.com Ready-made survey to measure product-market fit. Send to users, get your PMF score. The 40% “very disappointed” benchmark. No setup required.

Sequoia Arc PMF Framework (Free)

https://sequoiacap.com/article/pmf-framework/ Sequoia’s internal framework, now publicly available. Three archetypes of PMF. The best mental model for understanding where you are.

Fundraising Documents

EWOR Startup Templates (Free)

https://www.ewor.com/startup-templates Co-Founder Conversation Starter, OKR templates, Investor Update templates, Financial Model templates, Pitch Deck guidelines, Data Room templates. Excellent quality, free download.

Learning (Beyond the Reading List)

YC Startup School (Free)

https://www.startupschool.org 7-week free curriculum + 20+ hours of lectures. Pick the ones relevant to your current module.

TechStars Entrepreneur's Toolkit (Free)

https://toolkit.techstars.com Modules on Lean Canvas, pitch, PMF (W3 framework), and founder mental health. Concise and practical.

First Round Review

https://review.firstround.com The best long-form articles on startup building. Searchable by topic. Start with their "Must Reads" collection.

a16z AI Canon

https://a16z.com/ai-canon/ Curated list of the most important AI papers, courses, and guides. Essential for AI-first founders.

Indie Hackers

https://www.indiehackers.com Real founders sharing real revenue numbers, strategies, and struggles. Good for staying grounded.